

CASE ID: 202102710713

**EPISODE NAME: China pineapple ban on Taiwan 2021**

2021/02/26 - Ongoing

Sender: China (710)

Target: Taiwan (713)

Issue: Contain Political Influence (1)

Final Outcome: Ongoing

**Narrative:**

On 2021/02/26, China imposed a ban on pineapple imports from Taiwan, citing concerns over pests allegedly found in shipments.<sup>1</sup> This move was perceived as politically motivated and “aimed at impacting Taiwanese farmers”<sup>2</sup>. The ban affected a significant portion of Taiwan's pineapple exports, as China was one of its largest markets.<sup>3</sup>

The Taiwanese government and farmers quickly responded to the ban by seeking alternative markets and encouraging domestic consumption. The "Freedom Pineapple" campaign was launched, urging citizens and international allies to support Taiwanese pineapples.<sup>4</sup> The campaign garnered widespread attention and solidarity, with countries such as Japan stepping up to import more Taiwanese pineapples.<sup>5</sup>

The ban is still in place.

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<sup>1</sup> Lin Chia-nan. “PRC bans import of Taiwan pineapples.” *Taipei Times*, 27 February, 2021.

<https://www.taipeitimes.com/News/front/archives/2021/02/27/2003752913>

<sup>2</sup> Brian Hioe (2022). “China Slaps Export Bans on Taiwanese Goods – Again,” December 16, 2022.

<https://thedi diplomat.com/2022/12/china-slaps-export-bans-on-taiwanese-goods-again/#:~:text=Similarly%2C%20the%20Chinese%20government's%20decision,have%20nowhere%20else%20to%20go.>

<sup>3</sup> Ibid.

<sup>4</sup> Nick Aspinwall (2021) “Taiwan Promotes ‘Freedom Pineapples’ in Response to Chinese Import Ban,” March 06, 2021. <https://thedi diplomat.com/2021/03/taiwan-promotes-freedom-pineapples-in-response-to-chinese-import-ban/>.

<sup>5</sup> Betty Hou (2021). “China’s Ban on Taiwan Pineapples Backfires as New Buyers Step In,” *Bloomberg*, August 5, 2021, <https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2021-08-05/china-s-ban-on-taiwan-pineapples-backfires-as-new-buyers-step-in?embedded-checkout=true>.